

SkyPath — Student Traveller Persona

Persona profile • UX research synthesis • Airline booking experience

Persona type	Budget-conscious / independent traveller
Primary context	Domestic or international study-related travel
Core motivation	Find a practical, affordable flight while retaining control over important travel decisions
Key priorities	Total cost, baggage, schedule, flexibility, comparison clarity, mobile-friendly interaction
Typical behaviour	Explores several options, compares trade-offs and checks inclusions before committing

Persona Snapshot

The student traveller is often highly cost-conscious but does not necessarily choose the cheapest advertised fare. The decision depends on the relationship between total price, baggage allowance, travel time, schedule and what is included in the fare.

Because the booking may involve unfamiliar routes, international travel or limited prior experience, the student benefits from clear explanations, visible trade-offs and a workflow that prevents expensive mistakes.

Goals

- Find flights that fit a limited or carefully managed travel budget.
- Compare total costs rather than relying only on the headline fare.
- Understand baggage, seat and other fare inclusions before payment.
- Evaluate flexible dates and alternative flight options when appropriate.
- Complete the booking confidently without unexpected charges.
- Keep itinerary and booking information easy to access after purchase.

Behaviours & Decision Patterns

- Explores multiple flight options before making a decision.
- Pays close attention to price differences between comparable flights.
- Checks baggage and fare inclusions because additional charges can materially affect the decision.
- May trade a small amount of extra travel time for a meaningful reduction in total cost.
- Uses digital tools comfortably but still benefits from clear guidance at complex steps.
- Seeks reassurance before payment, especially when travelling internationally or managing a larger expense.

Pain Points

- Low headline prices that become significantly higher after extras.
- Difficulty understanding what different fare types include.
- Comparison interfaces that emphasise price while hiding important trade-offs.
- Unexpected baggage, seat or service charges.

- Complex forms or terminology that make the booking process feel uncertain.
- Weak visibility of booking details after payment.

Needs from SkyPath

- Clear total-price comparison.
- Visible baggage and fare inclusion information.
- Straightforward explanations of fare differences.
- Flexible and easy-to-understand search controls.
- Progressive disclosure that keeps the interface simple without hiding important details.
- Accessible confirmation and post-booking information.

Design Implications

The student traveller reinforces the need for SkyPath to treat price transparency as more than displaying a single fare. The interface should help users understand the actual value and cost of each option before they commit.

Persona need	Design implication
Budget awareness	Show meaningful total-price information early in the comparison process.
Fare understanding	Clearly explain what is included and what requires an additional payment.
Comparison confidence	Support side-by-side evaluation of price, duration, stops and key inclusions.
Error prevention	Use clear labels, summaries and review checkpoints before payment.
Independent travel	Make important information understandable without requiring external assistance.
Post-booking access	Provide persistent access to itinerary, booking reference and relevant travel details.

Representative User Need

“Help me understand the real cost of my flight, compare the important differences and make the right choice without unexpected charges.”

Role in the SkyPath Design

The Student Traveller acts as a strong secondary persona for testing price transparency, comparison clarity and error prevention. This persona helps ensure that SkyPath does not optimise only for speed, but also supports informed decisions for users with tighter budgets and potentially less experience with complex flight purchases.